Topic 9 — Rise of Nationalism

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Political Organisations before INC | Zamindari Association | Bangabhasha Prakashika Sabha (सभा) | Freedom Leaders | Political Organisations | Indian National Congress (कांग्रेस) | Establishment of INC | Congress Presidents | Congress Sessions | Congress Policies | Moderates | Extremists | Tilak (तिलक) | Dadabhai Naoroji (नौरोजी) | Poona Sarvajanik Sabha | Indian Association | East India Association | Bombay Presidency (प्रेसीडेंसी) Association | Madras Mahajan Sabha | Ilbert Bill

Sources baked in: NCERT Themes III, Spectrum, Bipan Chandra, Ghatnachakra Purvalokan (Political Organisations / INC / Moderates–Extremists), UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — pre-INC chronology, Tilak never president, Moderates A/R, Naoroji 1901, sessions **Last verified:** September 2026 gap audit — Ilbert CCR + Surat CCR labels filled; Safety Valve table cleaned; Extra Drill present (no invented mega banks) **Current Affairs:** N/A (historical)

9.0 One clear picture — the arc of nationalism

Nationalism did **not** appear fully formed in 1885. Hold this arc; every card below plugs into one stage.

Stage	Rough years	Method	Key fact
Pre-Congress associations	**1866–1885**	Petitions, provincial lobbies	East India Assoc → Indian Assoc → INC
Congress founding, early Moderate phase	**1885–1905**	Prayer, petition, protest; safety-valve debate	Hume organises; Bonnerjee first President
Partition and Extremist rise	**1905–1907**	Swadeshi, boycott, passive resistance (निष्क्रिय प्रतिरोध)	Bengal Partition 1905 (बंगाल विभाजन)
Surat split and crackdown	**1907–1911**	Two rival wings; government exile/imprisonment of Extremists	Surat 1907; Mandalay deportations
Reunion and Home Rule	**1916–1918**	Lucknow Pact; Home Rule Leagues (दो लीग) (full detail **Topic 12**)	A.C. Majumdar; Besant/Tilak leagues
Gandhian mass phase	**1919 onward**	Mass satyagraha (सत्याग्रह) (full detail **Topics 13–14**)	Amritsar (अमृतसर) 1919 onward

Logic: Start every Topic 9 answer from the **stage**. Moderates are not "loyalists with no demands." Extremists are not "terrorists." Surat is a **split**, Lucknow is a **reunion** — never confuse the two 1900s-teen sessions.

9.1 Rise of Nationalism

- Modern Indian nationalism is the demand for **political rights and self-rule**, not only local caste or regional loyalty.
- It grew among the English-educated professional class after 1858, then widened in the Swadeshi and Home Rule years.
- Political causes included racial discrimination and Lytton (लिटन)'s reactionary years.
- The closed door of the **ICS** also fed political anger.
- Economic causes included the drain of wealth, high land revenue, the ruin of handicrafts, and famines under a rich empire.
- Social and intellectual causes included the press, railways, a common English-educated public, and socio-religious reform.
- Pre-Congress associations trained leaders in petitions, meetings and the press. Congress in **1885** gave them one all-India annual forum.
- Early nationalism was **constitutional**. After Partition of Bengal (**1905**) it split into **Moderates** and **Extremists**.

> **Logic:** Congress did **not** begin Indian politics. London, Calcutta, Poona, Madras and Bombay associations came first.

Ilbert Bill controversy (1883) — Cause → Course → Result

Viceroy (वायसराय): Lord Ripon (रिपन) | **Law member:** Courtenay Ilbert

Causes

- Under existing rules, Indian judges in the mofussil could not try European British subjects; European judges alone held that power.
- Ripon's liberal circle wanted to remove that **racial bar** so that Indian covenanted civilians could try Europeans in the same courts.

Course

- The **Ilbert Bill (1883)** proposed to allow Indian judges to try Europeans.
- Anglo-Indian planters, officials and the European press in Calcutta organised a furious racial campaign against the Bill.
- Educated Indians defended the Bill as a test of whether British justice meant equal law.

Results

- The government **compromised**: Europeans kept the right to demand a jury with a European majority.
- The controversy showed Indians that racial privilege sat inside colonial law itself, and it fed the political anger that pre-Congress associations and, soon after, Congress channelled.
- Hold **1883 Ilbert** as a **cause** of organised nationalism — not as a reform that fully succeeded.

> **Logic:** Ilbert Bill = **1883 + Ripon**. Result = **compromise**, not full equality. It is a **political** spark, not

> an Act that Indianised the ICS.

9.2 Political Organisations before INC

Bangabhasha Prakashika Sabha (~1836)

- Associates of **Raja (राजा) Ram Mohan Roy** (राम मोहन राय) started this early political discussion body in Bengal (**~1836**).
- Roy is tagged as the earliest Indian to push for **political** as well as social reform.

Zamindari Association / Landholders' Society (1838)

Year:1838Place: Calcutta **Founders:Dwarkanath Tagore** and fellow landlords

- Often keyed as the **first organised political association** in India using **constitutional agitation**.
- Aim: safeguard **zamindar** (ज़मींदार) rights — not a middle-class nationalist party yet.

> **Logic:** First political organisation key = **Zamindari / Landholders' Society, 1838** — not Indian Association 1876 (इंडियन एसोसिएशन).

Bengal British India Society (1843)

Year:1843Place: Calcutta **Link:George Thompson** (brought from England with Dwarkanath Tagore's help)

- Thompson's efforts founded this body; both A and R in the UP R.O. A/R stem are true and R explains A.

British Indian Association (1851)

Year:1851Place: Calcutta **President:Radhakant Deb**; Devendranath Tagore and others among founders

- Merger-line of earlier landlord–elite politics; more conservative than the later Indian Association.

Hindu Mela (1867)

- **Nabagopal Mitra (मित्र)**, inspired by Rajnarayan Bose, founded **Hindu Mela** to promote autonomy and **indigenous goods**.

Central National Mohammadan Association (1877)

- Founded at Calcutta by **Syed Amir Ali**.

Bombay Association (1852)

- Early Bombay political body often linked to **Dadabhai Naoroji** (August **1852** in chronology lists).

East India Association (1866)

Year:1866Place:LondonFounder:Dadabhai Naoroji

- Naoroji set it up to tell the British public and Parliament the Indian side of revenue, poverty and administration.
- It replaced the narrower London Indian student circles as a serious lobby.
- Indians and retired British officials both spoke from its platform.
- The East India Association (**1866**) is the earliest of the four; do not give that year to the Calcutta Indian Association (**1876**).

> **Logic:** East India Association = **1866 + Naoroji + London**. Indian Association = **1876 + Banerjee + Calcutta**.

National Indian Association (1870)

Year:1870Place: Britain **Associated with:Mary Carpenter**

- Mary Carpenter, the English social reformer, promoted education and social contact between Britain and India.
- The body was more **social–educational** than a mass political party (राजनीतिक दल).
- It sits **after** East India Association (**1866**) and **before** Indian Society (**1872**).

> **Logic:** National Indian Association **1870** ≠ Indian Association **1876**.

Indian Society (1872)

Year:1872Place: London **Link:** Indian students; **Ananda Mohan Bose** memory

- A London society of Indian students for debate and political discussion.
- It sits **after** National Indian Association (**1870**) and **before** Indian Association (**1876**).
- Do not confuse it with Naoroji's **1866** East India Association.

> **Logic:** 2024 order uses Indian Society as **1872**, item 3.

Poona Sarvajanik Sabha (1870)

Year:1870Place: Poona (Pune (पुणे)) **Circle:G.V. Joshi (Sarvajanik Kaka)**, **M.G. Ranade** and Deccan public men

- It claimed to speak for the people of the Deccan before the government (*sarvajanik* = public).
- It sent memorials on famine, revenue, and local representation. In **1875** it petitioned the British **House of Commons** for India's direct representation.
- Ranade used it as a school of Moderate public work. Tilak later moved in a sharper direction from the same Poona world.
- It is **not** the Bombay Presidency Association of **1885**.

> **Logic:** Poona Sabha **1870** = Deccan public body. Bombay Presidency Association = **1885**.

Indian League (1875)

Year:1875Place: Calcutta **Founder:Sisir Kumar Ghosh** (of *Amrita Bazar Patrika*)

- A short-lived Bengal political body just before the Indian Association.
- It wanted a stronger all-Bengal political platform than the older zamindar-heavy British Indian Association (1851).

> **Logic:** Indian League **1875** (Ghosh) is not the Indian Association **1876** (Banerjee–Bose).

Indian Association (1876)

Year:26 July 1876Place: Calcutta **Founders:Surendranath Banerjee** and **Ananda Mohan Bose**

- This was the strongest pre-Congress political body in Bengal (often called the most important pre-Congress nationalist organisation).
- Banerjee cleared the **ICS** selection in **1869**, but age trouble and a later judicial error led to his dismissal (**~1874**).
- He edited *The Bengalee* and later steered the **Indian National Conference** into Congress (**1886**).
- It agitated for **ICS age limits**, simultaneous papers, and against racial bars.
- It reached beyond zamindars to the educated middle class and students.
- Banerjee organised the **Indian National Conference** in **1883** and **1885** as all-India meetings. The 1885 Conference at Calcutta ran in the same season as the first INC at Bombay.
- Many of its methods and men later flowed into Congress.
- Among the four early bodies in chronology drills, Indian Association is the **latest** (**1876**).

> **Logic:** Indian Association = **1876 Calcutta, Banerjee + A.M. Bose**. Not 1866. Not Naoroji's London body.

Madras Mahajan Sabha (1884)

Year: 1884 | **Place:** Madras **Founders: M. Viraraghavachariar**, **G. Subramania Iyer** and **P. Ananda Charlu**

- Presidency-level political association for the educated public of Madras, formed in **May 1884**.
- Associated with *The Hindu* newspaper (started **1878** by G. Subramania Iyer).
- It demanded legislative council expansion, civil service indigenisation, and separation of judiciary from executive.
- It is one of the three presidency bodies named in the syllabus, with Poona and Bombay, and acted as the chief Madras precursor to Congress.

> **Logic:** Madras Mahajan Sabha = **1884**. Bombay Presidency Association = **1885**. INC = **1885**.

Bombay Presidency Association (1885)

Year:1885Place: Bombay **Founders:Pherozeshah Mehta**, **K.T. Telang**, **Badruddin Tyabji** (the **Trimurti (त्रिमूर्ति) of Bombay**)

- Bombay's elite political association, founded in the **same year** as Congress.
- It spoke for civic rights, councils and Indian officers in the presidency.
- Mehta became the Moderate "Lion (सिंह) of Bombay."
- Tyabji later became the **first Muslim President** of Congress, at **Madras 1887**.
- Do not date it in the 1860s. It is **1885**.

> **Logic:** Bombay Presidency Association **1885** ≠ East India Association **1866**.

Master Table — Chronology of Pre-Congress Political Organisations (1836–1885)

(High-yield for chronological arrangement & match-the-column questions)

Year	Organisation (संगठन)	Place	Key Founder(s) / Promoters	Core Objectives & Notes
1836	**Bangabhasha Prakasika Sabha**	Calcutta	Associates of Raja Ram Mohan Roy	Earliest body in Bengal for political discussion and reform
1838	**Zamindari Association / Landholders' Society**	Calcutta	**Dwarkanath Tagore**, Radhakant Deb, Prasanna Kumar Tagore	**First organised political association** in India using constitutional agitation; guarded zamindar interests
1843	**Bengal British India Society**	Calcutta	**George Thompson** & Dwarkanath Tagore	Collected and disseminated information on conditions of people in India
1851	**British Indian Association**	Calcutta	**Radhakant Deb** (President), **Debendranath Tagore** (Secy)	Formed by amalgamation of Landholders' Society & Bengal British India Society; petitioned 1853 Charter Act

Year	Organisation (संगठन)	Place	Key Founder(s) / Promoters	Core Objectives & Notes
1852	**Bombay Association**	Bombay	**Dadabhai Naoroji**, Jagannath Shankarsheth	First political organisation in Bombay Presidency; petitioned Parliament for representative government
1852	**Madras Native Association**	Madras	**Gazulu Lakshminarasu Chetty**	First political organisation in Madras Presidency; petitioned against East India Company misrule
1866	**East India Association**	**London**	**Dadabhai Naoroji**	Set up in London to lobby British public and Parliament on Indian welfare and Drain of Wealth
1867	**National Indian Association**	London / Bristol	**Mary Carpenter**	Promoted social and educational ties between Britain and India
1870	**Poona Sarvajanik Sabha**	Poona	**M.G. Ranade**, **G.V. Joshi (Sarvajanik Kaka)**, S.H. Chiplunkar	Premier public body of Maharashtra; petitioned House of Commons (1875) for direct Indian representation
Benaras Session (1905)	Gopal Krishna Gokhale	1905 (Varanasi/Benaras)	Gokhale presided; founded Servants of India Society in 1905; approved Swadeshi & Boycott movement against Bengal partition; Swaraj call first taken up.	

Year	Organisation (संगठन)	Place	Key Founder(s) / Promoters	Core Objectives & Notes
Calcutta Session (1906)	Dadabhai Naoroji	1906 (Calcutta)	Naoroji's 3rd presidency (1886, 1893, 1906); averted extremist-moderate split; passed 4 historic resolutions: Swaraj (Self-Government as national goal), Swadeshi, Boycott, and National Education; Flag of Swaraj unfurled by Naoroji.	
Surat Session (1907 / 23rd Session)	Dr. Rash Behari Ghosh	Dec 1907 (Surat)	Historic Surat Split between Moderates ('Naram Dal') and Extremists ('Garam Dal', led by Tilak, Lala Lajpat Rai); dispute over presidentship (Rash Behari Ghosh vs Lala Lajpat Rai) and retention/extension of Calcutta 4 resolutions; reunited at Lucknow 1916.	
Formation of Muslim League	Nawab Salimullah Khan (Founder/Host), Aga Khan III (1st President)	Dec 1906 (Dhaka)	Preceded by Shimla Deputation (1 Oct 1906, Aga Khan III met Viceroy Lord Minto demanding separate electorates); established at Dhaka during All India Muhammadan Educational Conference; Mohsin-ul-Mulk & Waqar-ul-Mulk joint secretaries; HQ Lucknow; annual sessions: Karachi (1907), Amritsar (1908); London branch (1908, Syed Ameer Ali).	
Delhi Durbar & Capital Transfer	King George V & Queen Mary, Viceroy Lord Hardinge II	Dec 1911 (Delhi) / 1912	Held Dec 1911; George V annulled Partition of Bengal (12 Dec 1911); announced capital transfer from Calcutta to Delhi (completed 1912 under Hardinge II); Bihar and Orissa separated from Bengal (proclaimed 22 March 1912, executive effect 1 April 1912).	

Year	Organisation (संगठन)	Place	Key Founder(s) / Promoters	Core Objectives & Notes
Delhi Conspiracy Case (1912)	Rash Behari Bose, Basant Kumar Biswas, Master Amir Chand, Avadh Bihari, Bhai Balmukund	23 Dec 1912 (Chandni Chowk, Delhi)	Homemade bomb thrown into Viceroy Lord Hardinge II's howdah during state entry procession; planned by Rash Behari Bose (escaped to Japan) and Anushilan Samiti; Amir Chand, Balmukund, Avadh Bihari, and Basant Biswas executed.	
1872	**Indian Society**	London	**Ananda Mohan Bose**	Formed by Indian students in Britain to foster political unity
1875	**Indian League**	Calcutta	**Sisir Kumar Ghosh**, Sambhu Charan Mukherjee	Aimed to stimulate nationalism among the middle class; published *Amrita Bazar Patrika*
1876	**Indian Association**	Calcutta	**Surendranath Banerjee** & **Ananda Mohan Bose**	**Most important pre-Congress nationalist body**; agitated against ICS age limit reduction (1877) and Vernacular Press Act (1878)
1883	**Indian National Conference**	Calcutta	**Surendranath Banerjee** & Ananda Mohan Bose	All-India precursor / dress rehearsal for Congress; held 2nd conference in Dec 1885 simultaneously with 1st INC
1884	**Madras Mahajana Sabha**	Madras	**M. Viraraghavachariar**, **G. Subramania Iyer**, **P. Ananda Charlu**	Premier precursor organisation in South India; closely linked with *The Hindu* newspaper

Year	Organisation (संगठन)	Place	Key Founder(s) / Promoters	Core Objectives & Notes
1885	**Bombay Presidency Association**	Bombay	**Pherozeshah Mehta**, **K.T. Telang**, **Badruddin Tyabji**	Founded in Jan 1885 by the "Bombay Triumvirate"; opposed Lytton's reactionary policies

Anti-Congress & Loyalist Organisations (विपक्ष एवं राजभक्त संगठन)

(Tested directly in UPPCS & Chhattisgarh PCS)

Year	Organisation Name	Founders / Leaders	Core Objective / Platform
1888	**United Indian Patriotic Association** (संयुक्त भारतीय राजभक्त सभा)	**Sir Syed Ahmad Khan** & **Raja Shiv Prasad (Sitara-i-Hind)** of Banaras	Formed to **oppose the Indian National Congress**, dissuade Muslims and Hindu landlords from joining Congress, and rally support for the British Raj
1893	**Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental Defence Association of Upper India**	**Sir Syed Ahmad Khan** & **Theodore Beck** (Principal of MAO College, Aligarh)	Formed to prevent Muslims from participating in national political agitation and to advocate separate Muslim political interests

Master Table — All 9 UP Sessions of the Indian National Congress (उत्तर प्रदेश में कांग्रेस के 9 अधिवेशन)

(High-frequency question in UPPCS Prelims & UP Special papers)

#	Year	City / Venue	President (अध्यक्ष)	Historical Significance / Landmark Event
1	**1888**	**Allahabad** (इलाहाबाद)	**George Yule**	**First British / Non-Indian President**; Lord Dufferin openly opposed session
2	**1892**	**Allahabad**	**W.C. Bonnerjee**	Second presidency of W.C. Bonnerjee
3	**1899**	**Lucknow** (लखनऊ)	**Romesh Chunder Dutt** (R.C. Dutt)	Famous economic historian (*Economic History of India*); demand for Permanent Settlement extension
4	**1905**	**Banaras** (वाराणसी)	**Gopal Krishna Gokhale**	Formal protest against Partition of Bengal; support for **Swadeshi movement**
5	**1910**	**Allahabad**	**Sir William Wedderburn**	Only British official to preside over two Congress sessions (1889 & 1910)
6	**1916**	**Lucknow**	**Ambica Charan Majumdar**	**Historic Lucknow Pact** (INC & Muslim League agreement); **Reunion** of Moderates and Extremists

#	Year	City / Venue	President (अध्यक्ष)	Historical Significance / Landmark Event
7	1925	**Kanpur** (कानपुर)	**Sarojini Naidu**	**First Indian Woman President** of the Indian National Congress
8	1936	**Lucknow**	**Jawaharlal Nehru**	Nehru declared **Socialism** as the goal of Congress; formation of All India Kisan Sabha
9	1946	**Meerut** (मेरठ)	**J.B. Kripalani**	Last pre-independence session; Kripalani was President **at the time of Indian Independence** (15 Aug 1947)

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q15

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2024 Q15):** Chronological order of pre-Congress organisations: **East India Association** (1866, London) → **National Indian Association** (1870/71, London) → **Indian Society** (1872, London) → **Indian Association** (1876, Calcutta).

9.3 Establishment of the Indian National Congress

Date:28 December 1885Place:Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College, BombayOrganiser:Allan Octavian Hume (retired ICS) **First President:Womesh Chunder Bonnerjee (W.C. Banerjee)Delegates:** about **72**

- Hume wanted a yearly gathering of educated Indians so discontent would have a **constitutional outlet**.
- The session was first thought of for Poona; it was held at **Bombay**.
- Delegates were lawyers, editors, landlords and professional men from several provinces — an elite start, not a peasant party.
- Early demands included Indianisation of the **civil service**.
- They asked for simultaneous ICS papers in India and England.
- They wanted expansion of **legislative councils**, a cut in military spending, and an enquiry into poverty.
- **Lala Lajpat Rai** (लाला लाजपत राय) and later **R.P. Dutt** argued that Hume founded Congress as a **safety valve**.
- On this view, Hume wanted to **vent** unrest so that it would not explode.
- Nationalist historians say Indians used Hume. They were not Hume's puppets.
- Congress was meant to meet **once a year**, pass resolutions, and go home. It was not yet a mass party with cadres in every district.
- Viceroy **Lord Dufferin** (tenure of the founding) mocked Congress as a **microscopic minority** / short-sighted minority.
- The **British Committee of the INC** was set up in London in **1889** under **Sir William Wedderburn**; it published the weekly *India*.
- At the **Bankipur (Patna (पटना)) session, 1912** (President **R.N. Mudholkar**), Hume was publicly called the **Father of Congress**.

> **Logic:** First session = **Bombay 1885 + W.C. Bonnerjee + Hume**. First President is **not** Hume, **not** Naoroji, **not** Tilak.

Safety Valve Theory vs National Awakening view (राष्ट्रीय जागरण)

Two rival explanations of **why** Congress began. Notes test both sides, not just one.

	Safety Valve Theory	National Awakening view
Core claim	Hume, with hints from Viceroy **Dufferin**, wanted an organised, loyal outlet for educated Indian discontent so it would not turn revolutionary	Congress was the natural culmination of decades of political work by pre-1885 associations, the press and English education
Who argues it	**Lala Lajpat Rai** first floated it; **R. Palme Dutt** later gave it a sharper Marxist edge	Most nationalist historians (Bipan Chandra and others); **William Wedderburn's** biography of Hume defends his sincerity
Evidence used	Hume's own private hints about secret reports of unrest reaching the government; Congress's early loyalty to the British connection	Growth of the Indian Association, Poona Sarvajanik Sabha, Bombay and Madras bodies **before** 1885; Indians used Hume's organisational skill for their own ends
How to treat it	A **theory about intent**, not a proven fact — treat it as one interpretation	The dominant classroom view: Congress channelled a **genuine, already-rising** national consciousness

- Hume genuinely wanted reform; Indians were not his passive tools. Both things can be true at once — that is the usual "both statements correct, but not causally linked" trap in A/R questions.
- Do not write that Safety Valve is a "proven British conspiracy." It is a **theory**, most associated with **Lajpat Rai** in standard keys.

> **Logic:** If a stem asks **who first suggested the Safety Valve idea**, the standard name is **Lala Lajpat Rai**. If it asks **who defended Hume**, the name is **William Wedderburn**.

9.4 Congress Presidents and Sessions

Year	Place	President / fact
1885	Bombay	**W.C. Bonnerjee** — first President
1886	Calcutta	**Dadabhai Naoroji** — first of three
1887	Madras	**Badruddin Tyabji** — first Muslim President
1888	Allahabad	**George Yule** — first English President

Year	Place	President / fact
1893	Lahore	Naoroji (second)
1896	Calcutta	Rahimtulla Sayani; **Vande Mataram** sung
1905	Banaras	**G.K. Gokhale**
1906	Calcutta	Naoroji (third); **Swaraj** used as a Congress goal
1907	Surat	Split; **Rash Behari Ghosh** vs Extremists
1911	Calcutta	Bishan Narayan Dar; **Jana Gana Mana** sung
1912	Bankipur (Patna)	**R.N. Mudholkar**; Hume called Father of Congress
1916	Lucknow	**A.C. Majumdar**; Moderate–Extremist **reunion**; **Lucknow Pact** with the League
1917	Calcutta	**Annie Besant** — first **woman** President
1919	Amritsar	Motilal Nehru
1920	Calcutta (Special)	**Lala Lajpat Rai**
1920	Nagpur	C. Vijayaraghavachariar (regular session)
1924	**Belgaum**	**M.K. Gandhi** — **only** session he presided
1925	Kanpur	**Sarojini Naidu** — first **Indian** woman President
1929	**Lahore**	Jawaharlal Nehru — **Purna Swaraj** (26 Jan 1930 Independence Day)
1931	**Karachi**	Vallabhbhai Patel — **Fundamental Rights** + National Economic Programme
1937	**Faizpur**	Nehru — first session in a **village**
1938	Haripura	**Subhas Chandra Bose**
1939	Tripuri	Bose again; then Rajendra Prasad after the crisis
1940	Ramgarh	**Abul Kalam Azad**
1946	Meerut (मेरठ)	J.B. Kripalani

- **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** (बाल गंगाधर तिलक) **never** presided over an INC session.
- Lajpat Rai, Gokhale and Subhas Bose **did** preside.
- Naoroji is the early leader who presided **three times** (1886, 1893, 1906).
- **Lucknow Pact is 1916**, not 1911.
- The **1911** Delhi Durbar package linked partition annulment with moving the capital to Delhi — not the Lucknow Pact.
- **Ramgarh 1940** came after Congress ministries resigned in **1939**, before the August Offer (अगस्त प्रस्ताव) and Cripps (क्रिप्स) Mission.

> **Logic:** Burn **Tilak = never President**. Besant **1917** is the first woman President. Sarojini **1925** is the first **Indian** woman President. Gandhi's only presidency is **Belgaum**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q50

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2021 Q50): Bal Gangadhar Tilak** was NEVER elected as President of the Indian National Congress, despite being one of its most prominent leaders. Lala Lajpat Rai (1920 Special Calcutta), Gokhale (1905 Banaras), and Subhash Bose (1938 Haripura, 1939 Tripuri) all presided.

9.5 Congress Policies (early years)

- The method was **constitutional agitation**.
- Leaders used petitions, the press, speeches, and memorials to Parliament.
- The schoolbook tag is **prayer, petition, protest**.
- On **services**, they wanted to Indianise the ICS, hold papers in India, and raise the age limit so Indians could compete.
- On **councils**, they wanted more Indians and more discussion of the budget. This was a step towards representative government, not yet full Swaraj.
- On the **economy**, they attacked the **drain**, high military spending, and revenue that ignored famines.
- On **civil rights**, they opposed racial bars in justice and jobs. The Ilbert controversy had already shown the wound.
- Moderates valued the British connection if it were run on British liberal principles. That is the **"Un-British rule"** complaint: the Raj was not living up to its own ideals.
- Extremists later said these policies had **no sanction** (no boycott, no mass refusal). Surat **1907** is that fight.

> **Logic:** Early Congress **did** have an economic programme (drain, poverty, military cuts). It was **not** a revolutionary terrorist body.

Moderate economic demands — checklist

Early Congress built a full economic programme around Naoroji's drain critique. Learn it as a checklist, not a vague "they wanted reform" line.

1. Cut the **drain of wealth** — reduce home charges (होम चार्जेस), pensions and guaranteed interest paid to Britain.
2. Reduce the **land revenue** burden; some Moderates wanted the Bengal Permanent Settlement (स्थायी बंदोबस्त) model extended to other provinces.
3. Cut **military expenditure** and demand a fair India–Britain share of defence costs.
4. Protect and develop **Indian industry** — tariff protection against Lancashire cloth and other British imports.
5. Provide proper **famine relief** and public works instead of revenue rigidity during crop failure.
6. Hold **simultaneous ICS examinations** in India and raise the age limit so Indians could compete fairly.

7. Expand **legislative councils** with more elected Indians and real budget-discussion rights.
8. Separate the **judiciary from the executive** at the district level to curb racial bias in justice (the Ilbert wound).

> **Logic:** This checklist is the "Congress **did** have an economic programme" answer to any statement claiming Moderates were pure loyalists with no demands.

9.6 Moderates (Naram Dal)

- Moderates dominated Congress from **1885** to the early **1900s**.
- The leading Moderates were **Dadabhai Naoroji**, **G.K. Gokhale**, **Pherozeshah Mehta** and **Dinshaw Wacha**.
- **Surendranath Banerjee** also belongs to this phase.
- They believed British rule could **modernise** India through law, railways and English education, if it were just.
- That is the Moderate belief that British rule could **modernise** India through law, railways and English education.
- They attacked exploitation as **"Un-British rule."**
- That meant a betrayal of British liberty, not a call to end the British connection overnight.
- The **"Un-British rule"** slogan attacked exploitation as a betrayal of British liberty.
- Both ideas are true for Moderates, but the Un-British-rule slogan does **not** explain the modernisation belief — they are related but separate Moderate ideas.
- Their methods were facts, books, budget speeches, and British friends in Parliament.
- Mass boycott was not their first weapon.
- **Gokhale** is the stock Moderate.
- He founded the **Servants of India Society in 1905**.
- He was Congress President at **Banaras in 1905**.
- Gandhi later called him his political teacher.
- After **1905** Partition, Extremists said Moderate methods had failed. **Surat 1907** split the two camps. **Lucknow 1916** brought them back together.

> **Logic:** Moderates criticised the economic drain; they were not blind loyalists. Both can be true without one explaining the other.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q135

Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2024 Q135):** Assertion-Reason: Most early nationalists considered British rule as an act of providence destined to bring modernization (True). They complained

against un-British rule in India without seeking direct severance (True, but R does not explain A).

9.7 Extremists (Garam Dal)

- Extremists rose as Partition of Bengal (**1905**) and the limits of petition politics became clear.
- The triad is **Lal–Bal–Pal**.
- Their methods were **Swadeshi** (स्वदेशी), **boycott** of foreign goods, **national education**, and **passive resistance** (निष्क्रिय प्रतिरोध).
- Swaraj was stated as a right, not a reward for loyalty.
- They used festivals, the vernacular press and volunteers.
- As a group they were still not the bomb-throwing revolutionary stream (that stream is **Topic 11**).

Lal–Bal–Pal — regional bases

Leader	Province / base	Paper	Signature method
Lala Lajpat Rai ("Lal")	**Punjab** — Lahore	*The Punjabee*	Swadeshi + Arya Samaj-linked mass appeal
Bal Gangadhar Tilak ("Bal")	**Maharashtra** — Poona	*Kesari*, *Maratha* (मराठा)	Festivals-as-politics; "Swaraj is my birthright"
Bipin Chandra Pal (बिपिन चंद्र पाल) ("Pal")	**Bengal** — Calcutta	*Bande Mataram*, *New India*	Swadeshi orator; theorist of passive resistance
Aurobindo (अरविंद) Ghosh (allied Bengal intellectual, not in the triad name)	Bengal — Calcutta	Editor, *Bande Mataram*	Ideological voice of "new nationalism"

Surat Split, 1907 — Cause → Course → Result

Causes

- Congress had planned a **regular rotation**: Naoroji presided at Calcutta **1906**; Bombay was to host **1907**.
- Extremists wanted the **1907 Surat session** to reaffirm the **Swadeshi, boycott and national-education** resolutions of 1906 without dilution, and pushed for an Extremist-line President.
- Moderates insisted on **Rash Behari Ghosh** as President and wanted to **soften** the 1906 resolutions.
- Behind the chair fight sat the deeper quarrel: petition politics versus assertive Swadeshi after Partition of Bengal.

Course

- At the Surat pandal in **December 1907**, the argument over the President's chair turned physical — shoes and chairs were thrown, and the session broke up in disorder before business could be conducted.

- Moderates then held their **own** session with Ghosh in the chair; Extremists held a rump meeting separately.

Results

- **Two Congresses existed in practice** until the **1916 Lucknow reunion**.
- The government used the split years to exile and jail Extremist leaders (Lajpat Rai's short Mandalay deportation; Tilak's long Mandalay sentence — table below).
- At **Lucknow in 1916**, **Ambika Charan (चारण) Majumdar** presided. Moderates and Extremists **reunited**, and the same session produced the **Lucknow Pact** with the Muslim League, accepting separate electorates as a bargain.
- **Home Rule in 1916** under Tilak and Besant carried Extremist energy into a new constitutional form (full detail in Topic 12).

Extremist crackdown — exile and imprisonment years

The government moved against Extremist leaders in the years right after Surat. Keep each leader's **penalty and year** separate — they are not identical.

Leader	Penalty	Years
Lala Lajpat Rai	Deported to **Mandalay** without trial under Regulation III of 1818	**May–November 1907** (six months)
Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Convicted of **sedition**; transported to **Mandalay**	**1908–14** (six years)
Bipin Chandra Pal	**Self-exile** in England to avoid testifying against Aurobindo in the *Bande Mataram* sedition case	**1908–1911**
Aurobindo Ghosh	Tried in the **Alipore Bomb Case**; acquitted, then withdrew from politics to **Pondicherry** (पांडिचेरी)	Case **1908–09**; Pondicherry from **1910**

> **Logic:** Surat **1907** = split. Lucknow **1916** = reunion + League pact. Lucknow Pact is **not 1911**. Lajpat Rai's Mandalay (लाजपत राय) (**1907, six months**) is a **different** event from Tilak's Mandalay (तिलक मंडाले) (**1908–14, sedition sentence**).

9.8 Bal Gangadhar Tilak

Life:1856–1920 (Ratnagiri; died Bombay, **1 August 1920**) **Title:LokmanyaPapers:*Kesari*** (Marathi, 1881) and ***Maratha*** (English) **Home Rule League:1916** (Poona / Maharashtra–Karnataka belt)

- Tilak taught at Fergusson College and worked with the **Deccan Education Society (1884)** before full-time politics.
- He turned **Ganapati Utsav (1893)** and **Shivaji festival (1895)** into public political schools.
- **Valentine Chirol** called him the **Father of Indian Unrest**.

- He accused Moderates of **prayer, petition and protest** politics. His funeral bier (**1 August 1920**) was lifted by Gandhi, Shaukat Ali and others.
- He **opposed** the **Age of Consent Act, 1891**.
- **Behramji Malabari (मालाबारी)** advocated the Act.
- Tilak's Extremist wing did **not** support the Age of Consent Act; Malabari did.
- He was jailed for sedition in **1897**, after the Chapekar context, and again in **1908**.
- He spent **1908–14 in Mandalay**.
- There he wrote ***Gita Rahasya***.
- Famous line: **"Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it."**
- He **never presided** over an INC session. He was a giant of the Surat Extremists, not a Congress President.
- In **1916** he started a **Home Rule League** beside Annie Besant's league. He died in **1920**, just as Non-Cooperation (असहयोग) was being shaped.

> **Logic:** Tilak = **never INC President + Kesari + Home Rule 1916 + opposed Age of Consent**. Gokhale **did** preside (1905).

9.9 Dadabhai Naoroji

Life:1825–1917Title:Grand Old Man of IndiaTheory:Drain of WealthBook:*Poverty and Un-British Rule in India* — 1901

- He was a Parsi teacher and businessman.
- He was the first Indian professor at Elphinstone.
- Later he was a merchant and public man in London.
- Founded the **East India Association (1866)** in London.
- He sat in the British House of Commons as Liberal MP for **Central Finsbury (1892)** — first Indian MP in that House.
- Drain theory said India's wealth left as salaries, pensions, home charges, profits and unequal trade (पण्याध्यक्ष).
- Poverty was **produced**, not natural.
- ***Poverty and Un-British Rule in India*** was published in **1901**. "Un-British" here means rule that violates Britain's own standards — the same Moderate vocabulary as the "Un-British rule" critique.
- He was Congress President **three times**.
- The years were **1886 Calcutta**, **1893 Lahore** and **1906 Calcutta**.
- At Calcutta **1906**, Congress adopted **Swaraj** as a goal in Naoroji's presidentship.
- He remained a Moderate in method and a radical in economic diagnosis. Gokhale and the early Congress treated him as the senior economist-statesman.

> **Logic:** Book year = **1901**, not 1900/1902/1903. East India Association **1866** is his. Three

> presidentships.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q139

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2021 Q139):** Dadabhai Naoroji's landmark book **"Poverty and Un-British Rule in India"** was published in **1901** in London, expounding the economic Drain Theory.

9.10 Freedom Leaders of the Early Nationalist Phase

A.O. Hume

- He was a retired ICS officer.
- He organised the **1885** Congress.
- He was **not** the first President.

W.C. Bonnerjee

- He was the first President, at **Bombay 1885**.
- He was a Bengali barrister.
- He did **not** found the Indian Association. That was Surendranath.

Gopal Krishna Gokhale

- He was a Moderate.
- He founded the **Servants of India Society in 1905**.
- He was Congress President at **Banaras in 1905**.
- Gandhi called him his political teacher.
- He **did** preside at Banaras (**1905**) — unlike Tilak.

Surendranath Banerjee

- He founded the Indian Association in **1876**.
- He organised the Indian National Conference in **1883** and **1885**.
- His book is ***A Nation in Making (ए नेशन इन मेकिंग)***.
- He was called "Surrender Not" in the ICS-age agitation memory.

Pherozeshah Mehta

- He was called the **Lion of Bombay**.
- He helped found the Bombay Presidency Association in **1885**.
- He was a leading Moderate.

Badruddin Tyabji

- He belonged to the Bombay Presidency Association.

- He was the **first Muslim Congress President**, at **Madras 1887**.

Lala Lajpat Rai

- He was the Punjab Extremist (**Lal** of Lal–Bal–Pal).
- He presided over the **1920 Calcutta Special** session.
- His book is ***The Story of My Deportation (डिपोर्टेशन)***.
- He **did** preside, unlike Tilak.

Bipin Chandra Pal

- He was the Bengal Extremist (**Pal** of Lal–Bal–Pal).
- He was a Swadeshi orator.
- He is not the stock “never president” trap in the 2021 set.

Annie Besant

- She was a Theosophical leader.
- She ran a Home Rule League in **1916**.
- She was the **first woman Congress President**, at **Calcutta 1917**.

Rash Behari Ghosh

- He was the Moderate President-tag at the broken **Surat 1907** session.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q26

Match **List-I** with **List-II** and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

> [!TIP] Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2020 Q26): **Nationalist Books and Authors:** The Story of My Deportation ↔ **Lala Lajpat Rai;** Gita Rahasya ↔ **Bal Gangadhar Tilak (written in Mandalay jail);** A Nation in Making ↔ **Surendranath Banerjee;** India Wins Freedom** ↔ Maulana Abul Kalam Azad.

9.11 Master Fact-Locks — Rise of Nationalism, Early Organisations & INC High-Yield Repository

Organisation / Session / Concept	Leader / Founder / President	Year / Place	Key Diagnostic Fact & Exam Anchor
Bangabhasha Prakasika Sabha	Associates of Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1836 (Calcutta)	Earliest political association formed in Bengal to discuss government policies.
Zamindari Association / Landholders' Society	Dwarkanath Tagore, Radhakant Deb, Prasanna Kumar Tagore	1838 (Calcutta)	First modern political organization in India to use constitutional methods of agitation; aimed to safeguard landlord rights.
Bengal British India Society	George Thompson (invited by Dwarkanath Tagore)	1843 (Calcutta)	Aimed at collecting and disseminating information on conditions of Indian people.

Organisation / Session / Concept	Leader / Founder / President	Year / Place	Key Diagnostic Fact & Exam Anchor
British Indian Association	Radhakant Deb (President), Debendranath Tagore (Sec.)	Oct 1851 (Calcutta)	Formed by amalgamating Landholders' Society and Bengal British India Society; sent petition to Parliament demanding separate legislature.
Bombay Association	Dadabhai Naoroji, Jagannath Shankarsheth	Aug 1852 (Bombay)	First political organisation in Bombay Presidency.
Madras Native Association	Gazulu Lakshminarasu Chetty	1852 (Madras)	First political organisation in Madras Presidency; protested company exactions.
East India Association	Dadabhai Naoroji	1866 (London)	Established in London to discuss Indian questions and influence British public opinion; branches in India.
National Indian Association	Mary Carpenter & Elizabeth Adelaide Manning	1870/71 (London)	Formed to promote social reform and female education in India; not a direct nationalist political party.
Poona Sarvajanik Sabha	G.V. Joshi (Chitnis), S.H. Sathe, S.H. Chiplonkar, M.G. Ranade	2 April 1870 (Poona)	Most influential body in western India; Ranade entered Nov 1871; submitted petition to House of Commons in 1875 demanding direct representation for India in British Parliament.
Indian Society	Anand Mohan Bose	1872 (London)	Founded to foster unity among Indian residents and students in Britain.
Indian League	Sisir Kumar Ghosh (editor *Amrita Bazar Patrika*)	Sept 1875 (Calcutta)	Aimed to stimulate nationalism and political consciousness among the middle classes.
Indian Association of Calcutta	Surendranath Banerjee & Anand Mohan Bose	26 July 1876 (Calcutta)	Foremost pre-Congress nationalist organisation; middle-class focus; campaigned against reduction of ICS age limit (1877) and Vernacular Press Act (1878); organised All-India National Conference (1883 & 1885).
Central National Mohammadan Association	Syed Amir Ali	1877 (Calcutta)	Pioneer political organization for Muslim community in India.
Madras Mahajan Sabha	M. Veeraraghavachariar, G. Subramaniya Iyer, P. Anandacharlu	May 1884 (Madras)	Coordinated political work across Madras Presidency.
Bombay Presidency Association	Pherozeshah Mehta, K.T. Telang, Badruddin Tyabji	1885 (Bombay)	Known as the "Trimurti of Bombay"; replaced dormant Bombay Association.

Organisation / Session / Concept	Leader / Founder / President	Year / Place	Key Diagnostic Fact & Exam Anchor
Indian National Congress (Founding)	Allan Octavian Hume (Founder & Gen. Sec.)	28–30 Dec 1885	Founded at Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College, Bombay (shifted from Poona due to cholera). 72 delegates attended. Name suggested by Dadabhai Naoroji (replacing Indian National Union). W.C. Banerjee presided. Viceroy Lord Dufferin mocked it as "microscopic minority".
2nd INC Session (1886)	Dadabhai Naoroji	Calcutta (1886)	436 delegates (33 Muslims); merged with Surendranath Banerjee's Indian National Conference.
3rd INC Session (1887)	Badruddin Tyabji	Madras (1887)	First Muslim President; 607 delegates (81 Muslims); appointed first delegate Subject Committee.
4th INC Session (1888)	George Yule	Allahabad (1888)	First European/British President; 1,248 delegates (221 Muslims); Governor Auckland Colvin opposed meeting.
British Committee of INC & *India*	William Wedderburn (Chairman), William Digby	1889 (London)	Established to lobby British MPs and public; published monthly/weekly journal *India* (1890–1921).
United Indian Patriotic Association	Sir Syed Ahmad Khan & Raja Shiv Prasad of Banaras	1888	Formed in opposition to Congress to keep Muslims and landlords aligned with British Government.
First Woman President of INC	Annie Besant	1917 (Calcutta, 32nd Session)	Anglo-Irish theosophist and Home Rule leader; first woman to preside over INC.
First Indian Woman President of INC	Sarojini Naidu	1925 (Kanpur, 40th Session)	Renowned poetess and freedom fighter; later first female Governor of UP (1947–49).
Youngest INC President	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad	1923 (Delhi Special) & 1940–46	Presided at age 35 in 1923; longest continuous pre-independence tenure (6 years during Quit India).
Gandhi's Only INC Presidency	Mahatma Gandhi	1924 (Belgaum Session)	Belgaum (Karnataka); endorsed Swarajist council entry agreement.
Historical Lucknow Session (1916)	Ambika Charan Mazumdar	Lucknow (1916)	Reunited Moderates & Extremists; Congress-League "Lucknow Pact" signed; Tilak proclaimed: *"Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it".*
Bankipur Session (1912)	R.N. Mudholkar	Bankipur / Patna (1912)	27th Session; declared A.O. Hume as "Father of the Congress".

Organisation / Session / Concept	Leader / Founder / President	Year / Place	Key Diagnostic Fact & Exam Anchor
Nagpur Session (1920)	C. Vijayaraghavachariar	Nagpur (Dec 1920)	Adopted Non-Cooperation resolution; reorganized Provincial Congress Committees on linguistic basis; declared policy towards Princely States.
Subhash Chandra Bose Sessions	Subhash Chandra Bose	1938 (Haripura) & 1939 (Tripuri)	Haripura (1938): National Planning Committee formed under Nehru; advocated Roman script for Hindi. Tripuri (1939): defeated Pattabhi Sitaramayya; resigned to form Forward Bloc (3 May 1939).
Independence Session (1946–47)	Acharya J.B. Kripalani	Meerut (Nov 1946)	President of INC during transfer of power and partition of India.
First Singing of *Jana-Gana-Mana*	Rabindranath Tagore (composer)	27 Dec 1911 (Calcutta)	Presided by Bishan Narayan Dhar; adopted as National Anthem on 24 Jan 1950.
Valentine Chirol & "Father of Indian Unrest"	Sir Valentine Chirol on B.G. Tilak	1910 (*Indian Unrest*)	Tilak filed unsuccessful defamation suit in London. Imprisoned for 6 years in Mandalay (1908–14) where he wrote *Gita Rahasya*.
Extremist vs Moderate Ideology	Lal-Bal-Pal & Aurobindo vs Naoroji, Gokhale, Mehta	1905–1907 (Surat Split)	Moderates: faith in British justice, 3Ps (Prayers, Petitions, Protests), colonial self-rule. Extremists: passive resistance, boycott, swadeshi, self-reliance, complete Swaraj. Bipin Chandra Pal termed INC a "Begging Institute". Lala Lajpat Rai termed sessions "Annual National Festival of Educated Indians".